Final Paper

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Introduction

Methods

Results

Figure 1: Native Grass vs. Non-Native Vegetation Over Time

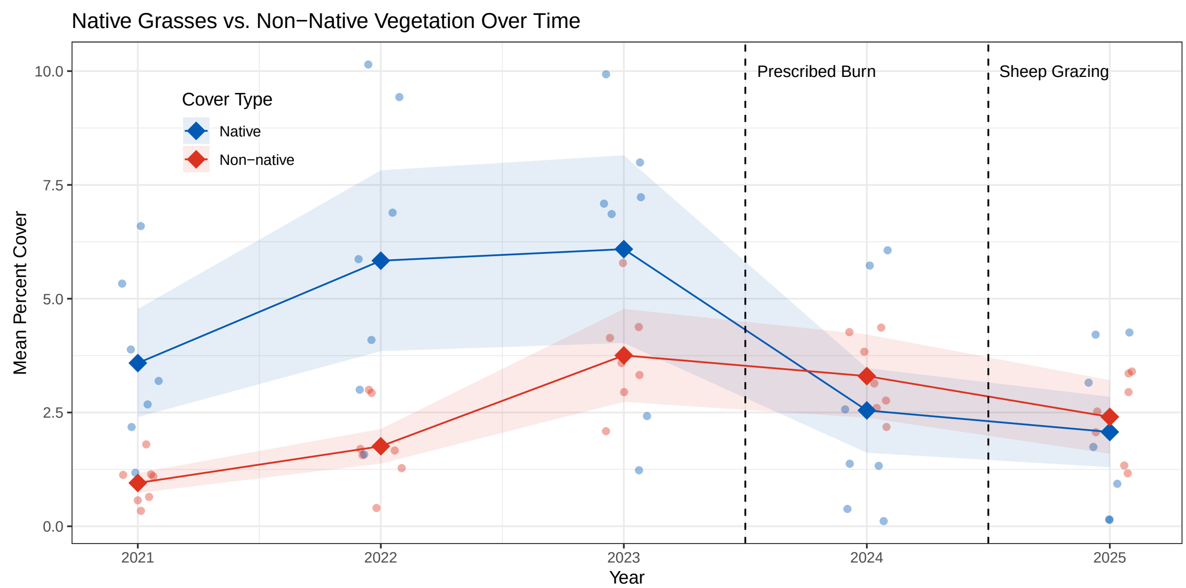

Figure 1: Mean percent cover of native and non-native grasses along the Mesa (GL) transects at the North Campus Open Space (NCOS) from 2021 to 2025. Filled circles represent the grand mean across transects and open circles represent individual transect means. Shaded ribbons show ±1 standard error. Dashed vertical lines indicate the prescribed burn (Fall 2023) and rotational sheep grazing (Fall 2024) treatment events.

Figure 2: Mean Percent Cover Change Before and After the Burn

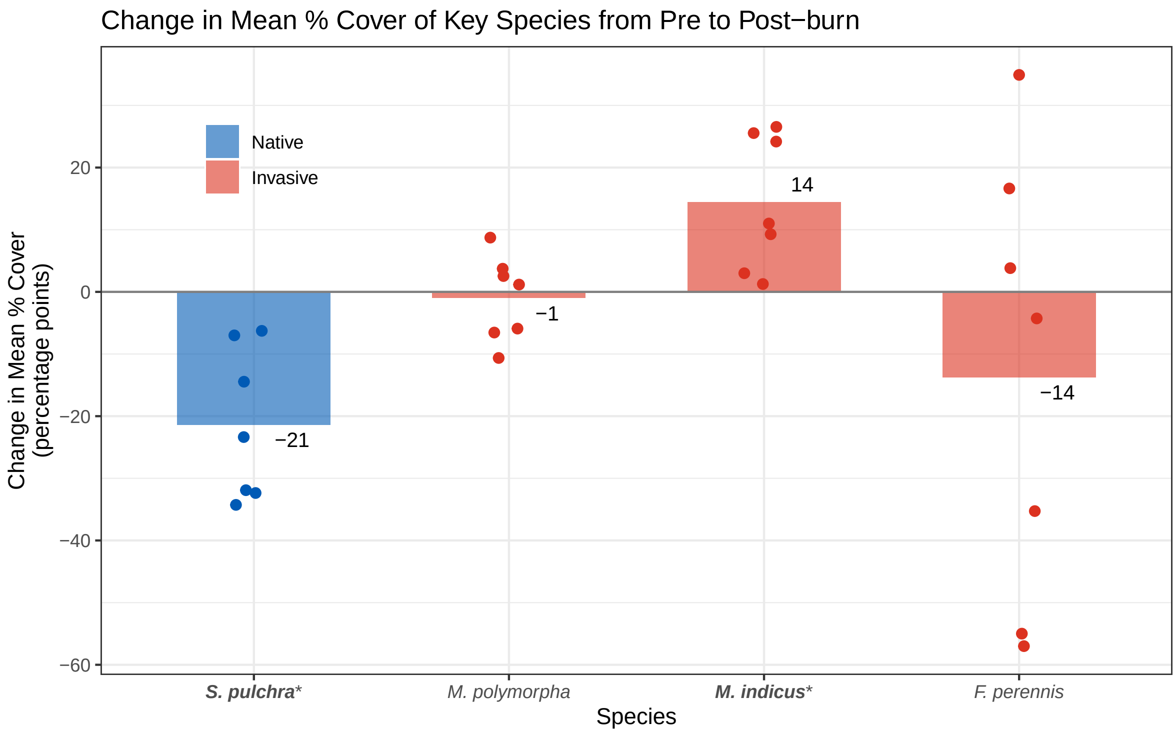

Figure 2: Change in mean percent cover of four key grassland species on the NCOS Mesa from 2023, pre-burn, to 2024, one year post-burn. Bars represent the average percent-point change in cover across transects for each species, while individual points show transect-level percent-point changes; the gray horizontal line represents no change, with values above zero indicating increased cover and values below zero indicating decreased cover. Blue indicates the native species, *Stipa pulchra*, and red indicates invasive species: *Medicago polymorpha*, *Melilotus indicus*, and *Festuca perennis*. Overall, *S. pulchra* and *F. perennis* decreased after the burn, *M. indicus* increased, and *M. polymorpha* showed little average change. This figure connects to our main question by showing that intentional disturbance did not affect all native and invasive species in the same way.

Discussion

References